

Muhammad Rafay Waqar

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SUMMARY

Policy analyst with hands-on experience at the IMF and World Bank Group (achieved through participation of University of California Washington Program), specializing in macroeconomic research, stakeholder engagement, and data-driven policy analysis for MENA and South Asian constituencies. Published author of 12+ op-eds in national newspapers on political economy and international affairs. Multilingual communicator pursuing a career in geopolitical risk analysis, AI governance, and policy research.

EDUCATION

B.A. in Political Science | Minor in Technology Management — University of California, Davis Class of 2026
International Baccalaureate Diploma — Learning Alliance School, Lahore, Pakistan 2019 – 2021

EXPERIENCE

Economic Analyst Intern — International Monetary Fund, Washington DC 08/2024 – 09/2024

- Conducted macroeconomic and financial policy analysis for the OEDMD constituency (Algeria, Ghana, Iran, Libya, Morocco, Pakistan, Tunisia), producing impact assessment briefs to assist IMF Executive Board deliberations across 7 member countries
- Delivered quantitative research, stakeholder briefings, and policy recommendations to the Executive Director and Senior Advisor, synthesizing data from IMF surveillance reports and member country datasets

Policy Research Intern — The World Bank Group, Washington DC 07/2024 – 08/2024

- Assisted the Executive Director's office by analyzing policy reports and drafting strategic content for work programs spanning 8 MENA countries; contributed to cross-functional stakeholder engagement across government and multilateral partners
- Produced country fact sheets and sectoral strategy input for MENA programs; conducted targeted research and data analysis for the Pakistan Country Strategy Framework 2024

International Student Representative — ASUCD, UC Davis, CA 05/2024 – 05/2025

- Elected to represent 6,000+ international students; secured funding for multiple student organizations through structured advocacy and stakeholder negotiation with university administration
- Organized 10+ cross-cultural panels, workshops, and events; facilitated direct dialogue between students and administration to advance policy changes for the international student community

MENASA Resources Community Organizer — UC Davis, CA 10/2023 – 07/2024

- Planned and executed 15+ community events (speaker series, cultural nights, workshops), averaging 50+ attendees per event; grew program reach by establishing 5+ organizational partnerships
- Built a digital outreach and strategic communications plan to strengthen MENASA community infrastructure across campus

Business & Economics Research Intern — SouthAsia Magazine, Lahore, Pakistan 12/2023 – 01/2024

- Researched and reported on international business, financial trends, and political-economic developments across South and Southeast Asia; translated complex macroeconomic and trade data into accessible editorial content
- Maintained editorial accuracy through rigorous fact-checking and copyediting across print and digital formats

Policy Intern — CoRe Alliance (Pakistan's first packaging recycling alliance), Washington DC 07/2023 – 09/2023

- Prepared policy briefs on circular economy frameworks, EPR and emerging UN global plastic treaty; identified partnership opportunities across 10+ multilateral organizations
- Drafted a legal and regulatory roadmap for establishing the Alliance's first international office in Washington D.C.

Founder — Water4Pakistan, Lahore, Pakistan 2019 – 2022

- Founded a multi-platform social media advocacy initiative on water conservation and pollution across Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter; crowdfunded \$5,000 to fund clean drinking water access for school-going children in rural Punjab

SELECTED WRITING · OP-EDS & FEATURES

Published 12+ op-eds in The News International, The Express Tribune, and Dawn on political economy, international affairs, and social policy (2018–present).

- "[The Last Barrel](#)," *The News International*
- "[Governing AI](#)," *The News International*
- "[Economic Agenda](#)," *The News International*
- "[Ukraine: Global Food Security](#)," *The News International*
- "[Genocides' Unseen Epidemics](#)," *The Express Tribune*

SKILLS

Policy Analysis · Macroeconomic Research · Stakeholder Engagement · Report Writing · Data Analysis · Strategic Communications · Statistical Analysis (R) · Stata · Python · SQL · Tableau · Power BI

LANGUAGES

English, Urdu, Punjabi, Hindi (Native) — French, Persian (Basic)